

Four-Year Performance Comparison (2014–2017)

Superstore Sales & Profit Analysis • Power BI Project

Overall Growth

The business grew from \$496,390 in sales in 2014 to \$750,780 in 2017 — a 51% increase over four years. Profit grew even faster, from \$53,770 to \$99,100, nearly doubling. Combined, the four years generated \$2,348,160 in total sales and \$303,820 in total profit, an overall profit margin of 12.9%.

Growth wasn't perfectly linear, however. Sales actually dipped slightly in 2015 (-3.2% vs. 2014) before accelerating sharply in 2016 (+29%) and continuing strongly into 2017 (+21%). This pattern suggests 2015 may have been a transitional or consolidation year, with real momentum building from 2016 onward — likely reflecting growing customer trust and repeat patronage as the business matured.

Profit margin stayed relatively stable across the period, ranging from 10.8% to 13.7%, and closed 2017 at 13.2% despite that year having the highest sales volume yet. This is a healthy sign: the business scaled revenue without sacrificing profitability.

Year-by-Year Summary

Year	Total Sales	Total Profit	Profit Margin	Avg. Discount
2014	\$496,390	\$53,770	10.8%	14.9%
2015	\$480,680	\$65,720	13.7%	14.6%
2016	\$620,310	\$85,230	13.7%	15.0%
2017	\$750,780	\$99,100	13.2%	14.8%

Category Performance: A Shift Worth Noting

In 2014, there was a clear gap between top-selling and top-profiting categories — Technology generated the highest sales (\$175,278), but Office Supplies delivered the highest profit (\$26,779). This was the year's standout insight: higher sales didn't translate to higher profit.

From 2015 onward, that gap closed. Technology became the leader in both sales and profit every year through 2017, suggesting either improved margins, reduced discounting, or a shift in product mix within that category over time. Furniture, meanwhile, consistently posted the lowest profit margin of the three categories across all four years (ranging 1.4%–3.5%), making it the business's persistent underperformer on profitability despite reasonable sales volume.

Region and Segment: The Steady Anchors

The West region led in sales for three of the four years, briefly overtaken by the East in 2015. By 2017, West had pulled well ahead again (\$254,040 vs. East's \$216,690), suggesting it's the business's strongest and most resilient market.

The Consumer segment was the single most consistent performer in the entire dataset — it led every year without exception, growing from \$270,810 in 2014 to \$338,870 in 2017. This makes Consumer the business's most reliable revenue base, while Corporate showed the fastest growth rate of the three segments, nearly doubling from \$134,290 (2014) to \$246,690 (2017).

Discounting Stayed Steady

Average discount held in a narrow band (14.6%–15.0%) for most years, with 2014 slightly higher at 14.9%. This suggests the acceleration seen in 2016–2017 wasn't driven by heavier discounting — the business grew demand and customer base without needing to discount more aggressively.

Customer Base: Broad, Not Concentrated

Across all four years' top-5 customer lists, no single customer repeats — every year's top spenders are entirely different people. This is a meaningful, checkable finding: it suggests the business's growth has come from a broadening customer base rather than dependence on a handful of loyal big spenders, which is generally a healthier, lower-risk growth pattern.

Summary

The business shows genuine, accelerating growth from 2016 onward, anchored by a consistently strong Consumer segment and West region. Technology emerged as the standout category in both sales and profit after an initial 2014 where Office Supplies actually profited more despite lower sales. Stable discount levels indicate this growth was earned through demand, not deeper promotions, while the lack of repeat top customers points to broad-based growth rather than reliance on a few key accounts. The main area worth watching is Furniture, which has consistently underperformed on profit margin across all four years.